

Printers are being designed for the living room



Canon claims to have brought a technological edge in printers with its Full HD Movie Print that allows consumers to capture and print favourite moments from Full HD movies. It has also come up with an intelligent touch system and Wi-Fi connectivity in its printers.

V.P. Sajeevan, director-consumer system products (CSP) division, Canon India, speaks to Uma Bansal, executive editor at EFY, about these and many other trends in inkjet printers. Excerpts:

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How is the demand for multifunction printers vis-a-vis single-function printers in India?

There is a drop in the sales of single-function printers (SFPs) because people are shifting to the convergence of copy, print and scan. More than 90 per cent of consumers are going for multifunction printers (MFPs). This demand is driven by home consumers. Also, the prices of inkjet MFPs have crashed to sub-Rs 4000. Inkjet MFP sales have grown 35 per cent over last year.

Why is this shift towards MFPs?

The reason is if you look at India, more than 70 per cent of users are beginners or still in colleges or schools. In more than 98 per cent of category-A houses, students get their homework or projects done on the computer. In fact, there are instructions from the school to download and print the learning material from the Internet. So there is a push from the school side and demand created for Web logging and Web printing. The printer is becoming a vital part for homework. They also then start looking for the external document to be copied.

Another interesting factor which we have recently found is scanning. We had thought that scanning will not have much importance at home but the scenario has changed now. Today, people who have MFPs at home have started

scanning their important documents like passports, property documents and marriage certificates and keeping them in electronic format.

What's the cost difference between single-function and multifunction printers?

Around 2000 rupees. But it makes a huge difference. The reason is if you buy a scanner, it costs Rs 3000 and you don't get all the features of an MFP.

What are the trends other than multiple functions and reduced price?

Aesthetics is playing an important role. Printers are being designed for the living room. These are miniature and come in varying curvatures.

Next is convenience. Today, homes have gone for Wi-Fi. Wi-Fi printers from Canon let you print from anywhere in your home. The tray automatically opens.

All Wi-Fi printers come with duplex printing—that's part of commitment to the environment as you use fewer number of papers. Instead of implanting a tree, you start reducing your consumption of paper. Wi-Fi printers cost upwards of Rs 5500.

Today, all inkjet printers come with a printing speed above 20 ppm. The reason is, at home you don't have time.